NATIONAL MERIT SCHOLARSHIP SCHEME 2026
Ministry of Education, Government of India
Notification Reference No: NMS-2026-EDU-01
Publication Date: 15 January 2026

Applications are invited from eligible undergraduate students for 10,000 national merit scholarships.

1. ELIGIBILITY REQUIREMENTS:
- Qualifying Examination: Bachelor's Degree in Science, Engineering, or Humanities.
- Minimum Academic Aggregate: 65.0% marks in previous qualifying degree.
- Age Boundary: Must not exceed 25 years as of 01 August 2026.
- Category Relaxation: 3 years relaxation for OBC, 5 years for SC/ST.

2. APPLICATION FEE & PAYMENT:
- Application Fee: Rs. 500 for General and OBC candidates.
- Fee is fully exempted (Nil) for SC, ST, and Female applicants.

3. IMPORTANT DATES & DEADLINES:
- Online Registration Opens: 20 January 2026
- Final Submission Deadline: 31 March 2026, 11:59 PM IST

4. MANDATORY DOCUMENTS REQUIRED:
- 10th Standard Passing Certificate (Proof of Age)
- Degree Marksheet / Consolidated Grade Transcript
- Valid Caste / Community Certificate (if claiming fee exemption)
- Active Bank Passbook Copy (for direct benefit transfer)

5. OFFICIAL SUBMISSION & CONTACT:
- Official Application Portal: https://scholarships.gov.in/apply2026
- Helpdesk Email: helpdesk@scholarships.gov.in
- Toll-Free Support Helpline: 1800-11-2026